

EMPOWERING WOMEN AND STRENGTHENING COMMUNITIES

Pernod Ricard India's Efforts Towards Transforming India

In its three-decades-long presence in India, Pernod Ricard has made an unparalleled and remarkable contribution to Indian society through its well-thought-out social initiatives. Living up to its vision of 'Good Times from a Good Place,' the company over its 30-year-long journey has genuinely left an imprint on the lives of billions of Indians. The company has brought the ethos of its rich global legacy to the core of its societal development interventions at the grassroots level in India making the experience truly 'Glocal' for every Indian. Their strategically designed programs have imbibed the holistic developmental vision of the Government of India and the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals with the aim to ensure gender equality, quality education and good health and well-being for all. As a responsible corporate citizen, the company diligently pursues the objectives of driving real change through sustainable solutions to address social, economic & environmental sustainability. Understanding the crucial role played by women who are the biggest drivers of change, the company's social engagement programs are geared towards creating an environment that fosters a deep sense of inclusion and provides opportunities, choices, and resources for thousands of women across the country. Pernod Ricard India's Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives are geared towards actively facilitating women empowerment. Until now, the company has played a vital role in enabling improved healthcare, education, entrepreneurial opportunities, and ownership within rural communities, benefiting over 125,000 women. One of their success stories is the Water, Agriculture and Livelihoods (WAL) Program which has been instrumental in breaking down societal barriers and enabling women in transcending the limitations of the four walls of their domesticity to contribute towards nation-building.

WAL PROGRAM: THE KEY TO COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT

Water holds a central position in advancing the cause of sustainable development. However, rapidly deteriorating water quality and groundwater levels have become a serious cause of concern. Combatting this challenge, PRI has been consistently working with a stakeholder-inclusive approach towards saving, replenishing and storing water essentially in rural areas. With over 70% of rural women engaged in agricultural activities as per the National Sample Survey data, women form the backbone of the rural farm economy in India and hence have a greater role to play in water stewardship programs. With the intervention of WAL, communities in water-stressed areas have successfully adopted a circular approach and have eventually become more conscious of water use and management. Ensuring women's participation at every stage has in turn resulted in increased water use efficiency, the restoration of water sources, and improved overall health of previously stressed local watersheds. With the involvement of PRI's WAL at the grassroot level, women have been able to overcome some of the challenges such as limited access to resources, gender disparities, and multiple social constraints. Courtesy of the increased participation of women in WAL, PRI is hopeful of the success and sustainability of the rural development initiatives which will further contribute to ensuring food security and sustaining rural livelihoods.

COMMITMENT TO WOMEN EMPOWERMENT: NURTURING WOMEN ENTREPRENEURS

Women constitute nearly half the percentage of beneficiaries under the Government's Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act Programme (MGNREGA) and over 70% of the Self Help Groups (SHGs) are women-led as per the National Rural Livelihoods Mission (NRLM) data. With women already involved in securing livelihoods via SHGs and contributing to local infrastructure